

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments and digital-asset product ownership.*

Positioning, Thirteen years owning product in regulated industries, with a fintech founding track that ran a P2P payments product to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem and hands-on crypto infrastructure experience across CEX, DEX and cross-chain venues.

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§ WHY EDISON SMART

The platform you describe, business accounts, cross-border payments, corporate cards, FX, treasury, and digital-asset wallets in one place, is exactly the combination that most B2B fintechs have only partially solved. The detail in the job description about settlement, reconciliation, transaction controls, approval workflows, and fiat-to-crypto conversion tells me this is a real infrastructure build, not a layer on top of someone else's product. That is the kind of work I want to own. *Building at that intersection, with a team that understands both rails, is where the interesting product problems live.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo feature delivery and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, inline coding and test scaffolding
- **Cursor**, refactors and codebase navigation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, research, edge-case generation, and PRD drafting
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder-facing presentations
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

- **Framer**, design-heavy prototypes
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Django, Git.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built and run solo.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, keeping onboarding friction near zero.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so one person handles the day-to-day operations.
 - Demonstrates the zero-to-one, multi-sided product muscle this B2B payments platform role needs.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT EDISON SMART

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

I would sit with the operations, compliance, and engineering leads to map the current payment flows, onboarding, funding, cross-border execution, settlement, reconciliation, and identify where the biggest friction points and manual workarounds are hiding.

WEEK 2

Slice and prioritise.

I would draft a first version of the backlog ranked by customer pain and regulatory exposure, align it with the commercial team's near-term targets, and get engineering's read on feasibility before anything is written in stone.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, close loops.

I would own the first PRD, run the delivery cycle with engineering, and set up the metrics, onboarding completion, transaction volume, settlement error rate, so we know within weeks whether what we shipped actually moved the needle.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Product Manager - B2B Payments & Digital Assets role. My background maps directly to what you are building: I co-founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile P2P payments fintech that ran inside the girocard ecosystem and was acquired and operated by Sparkasse. That role covered the full product lifecycle in a regulated fintech environment, payment flows, PSP integration, user onboarding, and the operational mechanics of moving money. I have also spent the past 13 years owning product in regulated industries, including B2B SaaS for insurance, public-sector analytics, and defence AI.

The platform you describe, business accounts, cross-border payments, corporate cards, FX, treasury, and digital-asset wallets, is a set of problems I understand at the infrastructure level, not just the feature level. I know how settlement works, why reconciliation breaks, and what it takes to build approval workflows that compliance and operations teams will actually trust. At EMIL Group I shipped the Claims Center from concept to production across an 18-person organisation and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week. At Rohde & Schwarz I reduced platform rollout time from days to 30 minutes through GitOps delivery. These are the same muscles a B2B payments platform build requires.

On the digital-asset side: I have 8 years of hands-on crypto experience. I actively trade and manage positions across centralised and decentralised venues, Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, 1inch, Across Protocol, across perpetual futures, spot markets, DEX aggregation, and cross-chain bridging. I study execution quality, market microstructure, liquidation dynamics, and routing. I have built my own dev-agent framework and a backtesting engine for crypto markets. My interest is in the infrastructure layer: stablecoins, custody, payments, settlement, and institutional execution. That is exactly the Web2 + Web3 combination your posting describes.

I write PRDs, user stories, and acceptance criteria as a matter of course, they are how I think through a problem, not a deliverable I produce afterwards. I have worked directly with banks, technology partners, and third-party integrators on both the payments and the data-platform side. I am comfortable in the detail with engineers and equally comfortable presenting commercial and regulatory implications to leadership.

Dubai is a location I am actively targeting. I am willing to relocate and work fully on-site, so there is no location friction here.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, including fintech, B2B SaaS, insurance, public-sector analytics, and defence AI. Co-founded a P2P payments fintech acquired into the girocard ecosystem. Strong background in payments, platform product management, cross-border financial workflows, and digital assets. I run continuous discovery, translate commercial and regulatory requirements into prioritised roadmaps, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams and making the platform hotfix-capable.

- Spearheaded the internal AI and data platform, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so data imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut roadmap to top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent.
- Cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government. Secure data platform and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

Healthcare. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - 06/2026

- Two-sided B2B marketplace built solo: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes to unblock enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile group-based P2P payments. Built from zero to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN | 03/2018 - 08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.
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§ SKILLS

Payments and Fintech: P2P payments, PSP integration, payment flows, girocard ecosystem, settlement and reconciliation, B2B financial platform product ownership, regulated fintech environments.

Digital Assets and Web3: crypto payments, stablecoins, digital wallets, CEX/DEX mechanics, cross-chain bridging, perpetual futures, fiat-to-crypto conversion, DeFi protocols, market microstructure analysis.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PRDs, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, epics, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning.

Technical Environments: REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, SQL, Django.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act; Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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